

Local Procedure 21: Selection and Appointment

Responsible Officer:	UCOP Chief Human Resources Officer
Effective Date:	5/5/2025
Scope:	Professional & Support Staff, Managers & Senior Professionals, and Senior Management Group Members Employees represented by a union should consult their applicable collective bargaining agreement. Policy-covered academic appointees should consult the Academic Personnel Manual. UCOP local procedures apply only to UCOP employees. Employees at other UC locations should consult their respective local procedures.
Contact:	UCOP HR Local Procedure

I. PROCEDURE SUMMARY

This procedure provides requirements for implementation of the systemwide [Personnel Policies for Staff Members \(PPSM\) 21: Selection and Appointment](#) for local University of California Office of the President (UCOP) employees.

II. PROCEDURE TEXT

A. Selection

1. General

Once recruitment is complete, the candidate selection process is conducted by the hiring authority (hiring manager, division/department leaders, the [UCOP Local HR Business Partner](#), and the [UCOP Local HR recruiter](#)).

The hiring authority will conduct the selection process in accordance with the requirements of the [Anti-Discrimination](#) policy, the policy on [Reemployment of UC Retired Employees Into Senior Management Group and Staff Positions](#), and these special employment considerations:

- Preference for reemployment for indefinitely laid off employees per [PPSM-60: Layoff and Reduction in Time from Professional & Support Staff Career Positions](#) and UCOP's Local Procedure 60. If an employee with preference for reemployment is not selected for a position, the hiring manager will write a justification outlining the reason for non-selection. The justification will be reviewed by the [Talent Acquisition Director](#). A candidate with preference for reemployment who is not selected for a position, can email the [Special Placement Coordinator](#) (SPC) to request information about the reasons for non-selection.
- Special reemployment for medically separated employees.

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- Reassignment for current employees per [PPSM-81: Reasonable Accommodation](#).

2. Release Time for UC Interviews

With advance notice (preferably at least 24 hours) and if the interview occurs during the employee's normal work hours, an employee must be granted reasonable time off with pay to interview for a position in another UCOP department or at another UC location, for a length of time equal to the time required for an interview at UCOP (approximately 1 hour).

3. Selection Process

The search committee or panel is charged with screening, interviewing, and recommending a group of qualified candidates for consideration by the hiring authority.

After all information is gathered from applications, interviews, reference checks, and other job-related sources, the hiring authority selects from the recommended candidates.

The recruiter or hiring manager will make an offer to the successful candidate. An offer letter that confirms the terms of the offer must be signed by the candidate to indicate acceptance of the job.

Candidates who were interviewed but not selected should be notified once the job offer to the successful candidate has been finalized.

4. Reference Check

Checking references is an important step in the recruitment process. The purpose of a reference check is to obtain information about a candidate's behavior and work performance with prior employers that could be critical to a hiring manager's decision. Reference checks should be reserved for your top final candidates, and we must always ask for permission from the candidate before we contact any references.

Process

There are two methods by which we can check the references of a candidate:

- Skill Survey online references – references are sent an online survey to complete.
- Reference Calls – The Talent Acquisition Recruiter or Hiring Manager will call each reference provided by the candidate. (The recommendation is to use this method for manager/senior positions.)

5. Record of Selection Process

The hiring authority will create a record of the selection process that includes:

- the employment application form for the selected candidate
- resumes of all qualified applicants (applicants who meet minimum job requirements)
- the job-related standards used to screen the applicants

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- the questions used for all interviews, including phone screens, search committees, and panels

After the candidate is hired, the record of the selection process is recorded on the Interview data form (IDF) that will be maintained by UCOP Local HR Talent Acquisition team for reporting and auditing purposes.

B. Review of a UC Personnel File

Per Section III.C of [PPSM-21](#), if a candidate recommended for hire is a current or former UC employee, the hiring manager should request that the HR Business Partner review the employee's personnel file. To review a personnel file:

- The hiring authority or recruiter should contact the final candidate and notify them that their UC personnel file will be reviewed as part of the reference check process.
- The candidate should provide the name and contact information of their current or former HR representative or HR Business Partner.
- The HRBP will reach out to the campus HR representative to review a copy of the personnel file. If the campus HR representative has not responded within three (3) business days, the request will be escalated to the campus Chief Human Resources Officer.
- If the file contains any adverse information related to the prospective job, the UCOP Local HR Business Partner should consult with the Talent Acquisition Director of UCOP local HR. The [Talent Acquisition Director](#) of UCOP local HR will consult with the hiring authority, the [HRBP Director](#), and [UC Legal](#) to determine the appropriate course of action.

C. Background Checks

1. General

A background check is required for a candidate for employment to a critical position (as designated by the [Chief Human Resources Officer of UCOP Local HR](#) per the requirements of Section V of PPSM-21).

The background check process is coordinated by [UCOP Local HR Talent Acquisition](#) and funded by the hiring division/department. An outside vendor conducts the background check service and provides verification of the information requested. Information should be requested based on the requirements of the position, which may include:

- State and federal criminal check
- Credit report
- DMV record credential verification
- Social Security verification (DTEC)
- Verification of educational degree, license, or certificate

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- Employment history

A background check is conducted when a current employee is promoted or reclassified into a critical position. The background check must be successfully passed for the employee to be promoted or reclassified.

If a background check for a current employee uncovers any adverse information, the [Talent Acquisition Director](#) of UCOP local HR will consult with the [HRBP Director](#) and [UC Legal](#) to determine the appropriate course of action. The hiring department will be informed of the issue. informing the hiring department of the issue

2. Record of Background Checks

[UCOP Local HR Talent Acquisition](#) will maintain a confidential log of all background checks completed for critical positions at UCOP. The log will include the title of the critical position, background check options included, date of background check, date of hire/promotion, department, unit, name of applicant/incumbent, and whether the background check was passed.

D. Misconduct Disclosure Review

1. General

The UCOP HR Talent Acquisition team will oversee the misconduct review check process in collaboration with an external vendor, who will manage the collection of candidate disclosures and release forms. This process is coordinated by the Local HR Talent Acquisition team at UCOP and funded by the hiring division or department.

As a condition of employment, the finalist will be required to disclose if they are subject to any final administrative or judicial decisions within the last seven years determining that they committed any misconduct, are currently being investigated for misconduct, left a position during an investigation for alleged misconduct have filed an appeal with a previous employer.

Process

- Job postings on the [UC Careers](#) website will include a notice about this requirement (this is not required for third-party job postings or external job boards).
- The Talent Acquisition recruiter will inform applicants about these requirements during the application submission process, along with other standard disclosures.
- Final candidates must complete a misconduct disclosure form covering the past seven years.
- Final candidates must sign a release form authorizing UCOP to request information from their current or former employer(s) regarding disclosed misconduct.

2. Record of Misconduct Disclosure Review

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[UCOP Local HR Talent Acquisition](#) team will maintain a confidential log of all misconduct disclosure review checks completed for faculty, staff and students. The log will include:

- Title of the critical position
- Misconduct disclosure review check options included
- Date of misconduct disclosure review check
- Date of hire/promotion
- Department
- Unit
- Name of applicant/incumbent
- Whether the misconduct review check was passed

E. Employment of Near Relatives

Requirements for employment of near relatives are described in Section III.F of [PPSM-21](#).

A written request to hire a near relative should be submitted from the division/department head to the CHRO of UCOP Local HR for review and approval before making a job offer. The request should include:

- the reason the near relative should be hired;
- the near relative's special skills;
- appointment type and percentage; and
- a description of efforts made to find other qualified candidates.

III. COMPLIANCE/RESPONSIBILITIES

A. Implementation of the Procedure

The [Chief Human Resources Officer \(CHRO\) of UCOP Local Human Resources \(HR\)](#) is the Responsible Officer for this procedure and has the authority, in consultation with the appropriate UCOP leadership, to implement the procedure. The Responsible Officer may develop other supplementary information to support the implementation of this procedure. These procedures apply to all units under the jurisdiction of UCOP, including UCPATH.

B. Revisions to the Procedure

UC local procedures supplement [systemwide Presidential policies](#). When a systemwide policy is updated, the corresponding local procedure will be updated accordingly.

The CHRO of UCOP Local HR has the authority to initiate revisions to the procedure and ensure that procedures are regularly reviewed and updated, consistent with other UC policies, procedures, and applicable law.

C. Approval of Actions

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All actions applicable to employees covered by this procedure that exceed this procedure (i.e. exceptions) must be approved by the CHRO of UCOP Local HR, consistent with the requirements of the applicable systemwide policy. Requests for exceptions to the applicable systemwide policy must be made to the officer described in that policy.

D. Compliance with the Procedure and Applicable Systemwide Policy

If there is a conflict between a local procedure and a systemwide policy, the content of the systemwide policy governs. Individual departments may maintain documented processes applicable to their internal operations or activities, but those processes may not conflict with this procedure or the applicable systemwide policy.

The CHRO of UCOP Local HR is responsible for the administration of this procedure.

IV. RELATED INFORMATION

- [PPSM-21](#): Selection and Appointment (referenced in Section I)
- [Anti-Discrimination](#) (referenced in Section II.A.1)
- [Reemployment of UC Retired Employees Into Senior Management Group and Staff Positions](#) (referenced in Section II.A.1)
- [PPSM-60](#): Layoff and Reduction in Time from Professional and Support Staff Career Positions (referenced in Section II.A.1)
- [PPSM-66](#): Medical Separation (referenced in Section II.A.1)
- [PPSM-81](#): Reasonable Accommodation (referenced in Section II.A.1)
- Personnel Policies for Staff Members [62](#), [63](#), and [64](#) (referenced in Section III.E)
- [UC Sexual Violence and Sexual Harassment Policy](#)
- [UC Anti-Discrimination Policy for Employees, Students and Third Parties](#)
- [APM - 035: Affirmative Action and Nondiscrimination in Employment](#)

V. REVISION HISTORY

May 5, 2025: Revisions made to:

- Issuance of revised policy
- Streamline and clarify the information provided
- Eliminate redundancy
- Reorganized content
- Update web links and office titles
- Ensure compliance with Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.0

January 1, 2012: Initial issuance of procedure